

Shubham Dey

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Summary

Economist and meta-science researcher specializing in systematic evidence synthesis, meta-analysis, and AI-assisted research infrastructure. Currently Technical Specialist at J-PAL South Asia, leading evidence gap maps and systematic reviews for the India Climate and Health Data Capacity Accelerator (IDCA) in partnership with government agencies and social-impact organisations, alongside field measurement work on a large-scale education programme in Andhra Pradesh and Telangana. Experienced in building structured effect-size databases from published studies, harmonizing estimates across heterogeneous designs, and evaluating LLM-assisted tools for living systematic reviews. Research interests include behavioral and experimental economics, the economics of altruism and charitable giving, and meta-analytic methods for development policy.

Education

University of Osaka, Osaka, Japan

April 2024 – March 2026

Master of Economics

- Thesis: *Gifts Without Residents: Furusato Nozei, Charitable Giving, and Population Retention — Evidence from a Natural Field Experiment in Japan* (Supervisor: Prof. Michinori Uwasu)
- Selected Coursework: Applied Econometrics II, Behavioural and Experimental Economics II, Experiments in Development Economics, Microeconomic Analysis of Economic Development II

University of Hyderabad, Hyderabad, India

November 2020 – June

BA in Economics

2023

- Selected Coursework: Probability & Statistics, Econometrics, Microeconomics I & II, Macroeconomics I & II

Massachusetts Institute of Technology & J-PAL (online)

May 2026- Present

MITx MicroMasters in Data, Economics, and Development Policy (DEDP)

- Coursework in *Designing and Running Randomized Evaluations*
- Coursework in *Microeconomics* (J-PAL/MITx)

Experience

Technical Specialist

May 2026 – Present

J-PAL South Asia

India Climate & Health Data Capacity Accelerator (IDCA)

- **Evidence gap mapping and systematic review:** Leading evidence gap maps and systematic reviews on climate-health intersections in India, characterizing the existing evidence base, identifying research priorities, and locating J-PAL's randomized evaluations within the broader landscape of rigorous evidence – an applied metascience function within the programme. Supervising two MIT interns on evidence synthesis.
- **Government and sector partnerships:** Working with government agencies (Ministry of MSME, Ministry of Jal Shakti, TNeGA) and social-impact organisations (Arghyam, Farmers for Forests) to assess data availability and quality and map evidence needs across the climate-health policy interface.

Every Child Counts (Math Games) Scale-Up, Andhra Pradesh & Telangana

- **Field measurement and implementation fidelity:** Supporting measurement for the scale-up of J-PAL's Math Games early-grade numeracy programme in government schools across Andhra Pradesh and Telangana, delivered through a NGO cascade training model. Working with the training-observation, post-training assessment, and classroom process-monitoring instruments and SurveyCTO data flow to capture teacher behaviour change and fidelity of classroom implementation;
- **Learning assessment data:** Analysing baseline math and language assessment data for about 150 Grade 1 students in Pune and Delhi for a related early-grade learning study.

Research Assistant

August 2024 – March 2026

Institute of Social and Economic Research (ISER), University of Osaka

Advisor: Prof. Taisuke Imai

- **Price Elasticity of Charitable Giving (Meta-Analysis):** Built and maintained a structured, multi-table effect-size database, extracting and harmonizing 151 estimates from 33 studies across heterogeneous designs; developed a Boolean search strategy validated against 7 anchor papers; resolved moderator-coding inconsistencies and ran inter-rater reliability checks for data quality assurance. Conducted the meta-analysis and meta-regression in R. Promoted from RA to co-author in recognition of dataset contributions; R&R at the *Journal of Economic Behavior & Organization*, presented at ARNOVA 2025.
- **Client-confidential industry-funded research on interdisciplinary research:** Developed a systematic review

strategy for qualitative and quantitative evidence, screened studies for usable scales and measures, and structured paper-level information on definitions and study characteristics for a cross-domain review of interdisciplinary research novelty.

- **AI-assisted evidence synthesis and living-review infrastructure:** Conducted a structured review of AI/LLM-assisted tools for data extraction, screening, and meta-analysis, and of platforms supporting living systematic reviews and living knowledge bases. Tested and compared pipelines across search, screening, coding, extraction, synthesis, and continuous updating, documenting accuracy bottlenecks and practical use cases for research teams.

Publications & Working Papers

Published

- **Dey, S., & Uwasu, M.** (2025). [Brand or Be Gone: Cultural Commodities and the Struggle for Rural Survival in Japan and India](#) *Invited book chapter, Springer Nature Singapore, in association with Keio University, Tokyo.*

Under Review

- Clochard, G., **Dey, S.**, Sasaki, S., & Imai, T. (2025). [Revisiting the price elasticity of charitable giving: Meta-analysis of tax incentives and matching donations.](#) [*R&R at the Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization.*]

Additional Training

- **Working with Government (Managers' Track)** *July - August 2026*
J-PAL South Asia
Intensive course on engaging Indian bureaucracies: government partnership models, embedding research within departments, and navigating administrative processes
- **The Chicago School in Experimental Economics** *June 2026*
University of Chicago & Institute of Social and Economic Research (ISER), Osaka
Intensive training in experimental economics led by Prof. John List

Conferences & Presentations

2025: ARNOVA (Indianapolis, USA), University of Osaka (Osaka, Japan)

2024: Keio University (Fujisawa, Japan), University of Hyderabad (Hyderabad, India)

Grants, Awards & Fellowships

- Japanese Government (MEXT) Research Scholarship *2023 – 2026*
Graduate Research Grant, University of Osaka *2024*
YSI Young Scholar Travel Grant, Institute for New Economic Thinking (INET) *2024*

Skills

- *Statistical & Research Methods:* Meta-analysis, meta-regression, Bayesian model averaging, systematic review methodology, difference-in-differences (TWFE, staggered adoption, Sun–Abraham, Callaway & Sant'Anna), panel data methods, impact evaluation, experimental and field-experiment design (RCTs), survey design, and focus group discussions
- *Software:* R, Stata (basic), L^AT_EX, SurveyCTO
- *Evidence Synthesis & Review Tools:* Web of Science, Google Scholar, Covidence, Nested Knowledge, LLM-assisted review workflows

Refereeing

Journal of Economic Surveys (x2)

Professional Memberships

- Meta-Analysis of Economics Research (MAER) Network – Member *2026-*
- The Association for Research on Nonprofit Organizations and Voluntary Action (ARNOVA) – Early Scholar's Section (ESS) Member *2025-*
- Young Scholars Initiative (YSI), Institute for New Economic Thinking (INET) – Behaviour & Society Working Group *2024-*

Languages

- Bangla (native), English (fluent), Hindi (fluent), Japanese (functional - IJ200, University of Osaka)